

TRADESPACE

The fastest path from invention to filed patent.

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Applying for: Lead Counsel, IP, Zipline, South San Francisco, CA

SUMMARY

IP infrastructure built for exactly what this role owns: pulling patentable work out of engineering and product teams, running prosecution end to end, managing outside counsel, and building policy that scales with the company instead of getting rebuilt every year. Three years spent doing that for hardware and autonomy companies moving as fast as Zipline is.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called "game-changing" from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same "which three patents protect the core product" question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

- Invention harvesting across Hardware, Autonomy, and Software: structured, low-friction intake built because the best inventive work at a fast-moving autonomy company routinely gets missed, not because it isn't patentable.
- Prosecution and outside counsel management at scale: a vetted network of 235+ patent attorneys across 13 technology practice areas, admitted through a four-criteria review process, plus AI-drafting support for provisional filings, so managing outside counsel is a standing process rather than a relationship rebuilt firm by firm.
- Scalable IP policy: patent-to-product mapping that turns "which patents protect which product line" into an answerable question across Hardware, Autonomy, and Software, the same policy infrastructure a portfolio needs before it can scale with the company.

WHERE I STOP

Freedom-to-operate opinions, IP litigation strategy, and negotiating the IP terms of a specific commercial deal, that's legal judgment I don't have and don't claim to. What I can do is make sure the portfolio, the prosecution pipeline, and the outside counsel relationships are organized enough that whoever holds this role spends their time on judgment calls like that instead of chasing status updates.